

THREE-HORSE RACE: WHO WILL KEEP WICKETS FOR INDIA AT THE 2024 T20 WORLD CUP?

Each of the **three contenders** — Dinesh Karthik, Rishabh Pant and Sanju Samson — brings something different to the table.

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As Dinesh Karthik kept clearing the fence in an Indian Premier League (IPL) fixture against Mumbai Indians at the Wankhede Stadium, his old friend and the captain of the Indian team, Rohit Sharma, walked up to him, applauded, and said in jest, "World Cup ke selection ke liye push karna hai isko, shabash! Dimaag mein chal raha hai iska World Cup...(He's pushing for World Cup selection. He has the World Cup selection in his mind)."

On the face of it, that seemed like banter between two colleagues who have known each other since their formative years, but not quite. **Rohit's words were significant, with the T20 World Cup just a few months away and the national selection committee set to decide on the 15-member squad soon.** But what about Rishabh Pant and Sanju Samson? They are strong candidates for the job.

By the time the ICC tournament gets underway in the USA and the West Indies, Karthik will have turned 39. But his phenomenal form in this edition of the IPL as a finisher certainly makes him a contender. Featuring for a star-studded yet struggling Royal Challengers Bengaluru,

